## Key Messages

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- The Postrera harvest of maize and beans is underway all across the region, which should boost grain supplies in domestic and regional markets. This is lowering prices, of which wholesale prices had been steadily increasing for the past six months. This should improve food availability and access.
- PROMECAFE estimates crop losses for the 2013/2014 season in these three countries between 18 and 25 percent, which will reduce the supply of jobs for unskilled laborers by a similar margin as well as the incomes of poor households dependent on this sector.
- The composite price indicator in the international coffee market in October of this year was US$ 107.03/lb, 81 percent below the figure for October 2011. If prices continue to fall, coffee growers will reduce spending on their coffee plantations, affecting coffee rust control measures, whose effects could extend even beyond the year 2015.
- Poor households in Nicaragua and El Salvador are experiencing Minimal acute food insecurity (IPC Phase 1), while poor households in Honduras are classified as Stressed (IPC Phase 2) due to staple grain crop losses from the Primera season.

## Current situation

- The normal performance of the rainy season in the last three months of the year permitted adequate *Postrera* crop growth and development in most crop-producing areas of the three countries. Harvests of these crops, which will be completed by the end of November, are expected to fall within the normal range.
- The coffee harvest for the 2013/2014 season is underway in coffee-growing areas at altitudes of over 800 meters above sea level. The damaging effects of coffee rust on the growth and development of both last year's and this year's coffee crops are expected to reduce yields. The cutting back or pruning of coffee plants as part of efforts to control the fungus and the replacement of diseased plants with new plants, which have not yet grown enough to bear fruit, are also contributing factors to coffee production shortfalls. PROMECAFE